



YOU ARE **33 WEEKS AND 4 DAYS**

45 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

A foot is shown here with the toes spread out. Not all of the movements that you feel will be due to kicks; some movements will be shrugs or punches and some from the bottom or head as it touches the sides of the uterus.

“The size of your belly will increasingly be due to the baby alone as the amniotic fluid now reduces slightly each week.”

The amount of amniotic fluid that surrounds and protects your baby is now at its maximum and the placenta has almost completed its growth.

Amniotic fluid is essential for your baby's lung development, gut maturation, protein requirements, and temperature control. Adequate fluid also allows your baby to move easily since they are in an almost weightless state. There is about 1 liter (35 fl oz) of fluid around your baby. The range, however, is quite wide and “normal” can be anywhere between 300 ml to 2 liters (11–70 fl oz). Sometimes there is too little fluid ([oligohydramnios](#)), or too much fluid ([polyhydramnios](#)). In this situation you would be closely monitored and premature delivery might be necessary.

It's not surprising that the size of your uterus may not reflect the size of your baby since there can be so much variation in the quantity of fluid.

As the amount of amniotic fluid reduces in late pregnancy, your baby is not as well cushioned and her movements may become more obvious. If you are not feeling your baby move like normal, or having decreased fetal movement, it is important to notify your prenatal provider immediately..

WATERS BREAKING IN PUBLIC

One of the most common concerns for women in late pregnancy is that their water will break in public.

The reality is that the amniotic fluid is unlikely to gush out. It is much more likely to trickle out because in a head-down position, the baby will press down on the cervix and prevent the liquid from escaping. If it does happen in public, don't worry—you won't be short of people offering help.

FOCUS ON PARTNERS

Once your partner's labor begins, your attention will need to be focused on helping her both practically and emotionally. So in addition to helping your partner prepare her maternity bag (see [Items for your hospital bag](#)) in advance, it's a good idea to prepare a bag of your own.